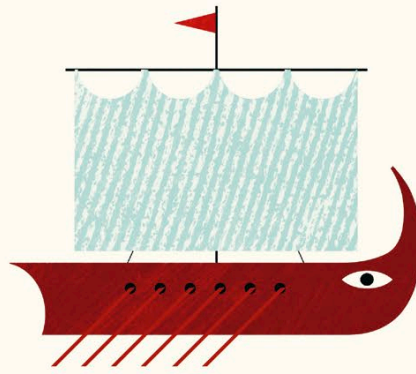




*After the Trojan War ended, the Greek heroes who had fought at Troy began their journeys home. Odysseus was the king of an island named Ithaca.*

Odysseus was desperate to set sail and return to his wife and son, whom he had not seen in 10 long years. Yet, his voyage home would be far from straightforward.

Odysseus and his crew set out across the sea, but before long they encountered trouble. In search of water, they landed their ships on an island—without knowing it was home to the Cyclops Polyphemus. The Cyclopes were one-eyed giants, a group of whom lived on a collection of small islands. Spotting a large cave up ahead, the crew went to explore and found signs that someone was living there. While they were still inside, they heard a flock of bleating sheep approaching.

*Odysseus's men were horrified to see an enormous Cyclops driving his flock toward them.*

It was Polyphemus returning with his herd. The Cyclops ushered his sheep into the cavern and pushed a huge boulder into place across the cave entrance, trapping everyone inside. It was only then that he spotted Odysseus and his men staring up at him.